

ISPs embrace Internet telephony

Following the unshackling of Internet telephony in April 2002 by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI), leading ISPs are all geared up to offer this service to subscribers. Sify, NOW, and HCL Infonet, along with most Category A ISPs

have made modifications to their infrastructure to build on this recent development.

The voice market in India is estimated to be around Rs 33,000 crore, of which Internet telephony might grab a share of 2 to 3 per cent. Currently, a call to the

US from India costs around Rs 55 per minute but with the introduction of Internet telephony, this cost is sure to come down drastically to Rs 33 per hour (Rs 25 to the basic telephone operator and Rs 8 for Internet access).

As per the TRAI recom-

mendations, the scope of this service will include only PC to PC (both within the country as well as abroad), PC to Phone (PC in India, phone abroad) and IP-based terminals in India to similar terminals both in India and abroad.

Hackers target mobiles

For hackers and virus writers, the mobile phone is the next frontier. As cellular phones morph into 'smart-phones' that can surf the Web, send e-mail and download software, they're prone to the same dangers that have plagued PCs. A phone virus might instruct your phone to do extraordinary things—it might forward your personal address book to a shady telemarketing firm. Or it could simply eat into the phone's operating software, shutting it down and erasing your personal information.

SMS bombers are available



ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

on the Net on hacking sites that allow you to flood ANY cell phone. Just send 10,000 SMS instantly to crash a cell phone.

Such attacks have already

dogged cell phone owners in Japan and Europe. In Japan, deviant e-mail messages sent to cell phones contained an Internet link that, when clicked, caused phones to repeatedly dial the national emergency number. In Europe, SMS has been used to randomly send pieces of binary code that crashes phones, forcing the user to detach the battery and reboot. A new, more sinister version keeps crashing the phone until the SMS message is deleted from the carrier's server. At least three software companies have released personal security software for emerging smart phones.

snapshot

Popular activities on the Internet include
e-mail **90%**
banking **37%**
job searches **31%**

Source: www.ucsi.cc



heroes

Xbox

Voice recognition for the Xbox will allow you to interact verbally with the game environment.

MS Visual J#

Newly released Visual J# .NET will allow programmers to code for the .NET platform using Java.



zeroes

XP Phantom Menace

WinXP integrated with speech recognition capabilities runs amok and disturbs users.

Yahoo!

Cuts down POP3 access and imposes fee on the same.

64-bit computing and you

Yamhill Technology is Intel's secret weapon against upcoming chips from rival AMD. It's also a safeguard against the possible failure of Intel's Itanium chips for



computer servers, which have so far had a disappointing reception. Apparently Yamhill is Intel's 64-bit plan B. Itanium faces performance comparisons not just from AMD's Hammer, but also from Sun and

IBM who also are investing heavily in their 64-bit processors. And of course, with AMD bringing in a 64-bit, backward-compatible x86 chip to the market, there's a fair chance we'll see affordable 64-bit computing for the x86 platform sooner than anyone anticipated.